

Day 77 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in TN History/Culture/Heritage (4): TN Diaspora Awards 2026 & TN's Padma Award Recipients

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Tamil Nadu Diaspora Awards 2026 (a global Tamil-community honours programme) and Tamil Nadu's individual recipients within the national Padma Awards 2026.

Q: What are the Tamil Nadu Diaspora Awards 2026, and when/where were they held?

A: A Tamil Nadu government honours programme recognising overseas Tamil community members across sectors (education, community development, women empowerment, trade, science & technology, medicine) — held in Chennai in February 2026, with delegates from over 70 countries.

Q: What is the purpose of the TN Diaspora Awards, per the Chief Minister's framing?

A: To urge the global Tamil community to preserve their Tamil identity, language, and cultural roots — institutionalising recognition that strengthens emotional bonds between Tamil Nadu and overseas Tamil communities.

Q: What is the 'Tamil Mamani Award' (2026), and who received it?

A: A TN Diaspora Award category recognising social justice promotion — awarded to Dr. Annamalai.

Q: Who is Tamil Nadu's sole Padma Vibhushan recipient in the 2026 Padma Awards, and in which field?

A: N. Rajam — a renowned Indian classical violinist, celebrated for popularising the 'singing violin' technique.

Q: Which Tamil Nadu Padma Shri 2026 recipient was honoured for Silambam (traditional martial art)?

A: K. Pajanivel — a Silambam master from Puducherry who has trained thousands of students over 3+ decades, helping preserve India's martial heritage.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Tamil Nadu Diaspora Awards 2026 were held in which city?

- A. Madurai
- B. Coimbatore
- C. Chennai ✓**
- D. Tiruchirappalli

Explanation: Chennai (February 2026). [medium, web-research]

2. Delegates from how many countries attended the Tamil Nadu Diaspora Awards 2026?

- A. Over 30
- B. Over 50
- C. Over 70 ✓**
- D. Over 100

Explanation: Over 70 countries. [hard, web-research]

3. The 'Tamil Mamani Award' 2026, recognising social justice promotion, was given to:

- A. Dr. Annamalai ✓**
- B. Sathiyavel Muruganar
- C. Nellai Jayantha
- D. Yugabharathi

Explanation: Dr. Annamalai. [hard, web-research]

4. Tamil Nadu's sole Padma Vibhushan recipient in 2026, violinist N. Rajam, is known for popularising:

- A. The 'singing violin' technique ✓**
- B. Carnatic fusion jazz
- C. The veena-violin duet format
- D. Western classical violin in India

Explanation: The 'singing violin' technique. [medium, web-research]

5. K. Pajanivel received the Padma Shri 2026 for his work in:

A. Bharatanatyam

B. Silambam (martial arts) ✓

C. Carnatic vocal music

D. Tamil cinema

Explanation: Silambam (martial arts). [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Dice

READING MATERIAL

Dice is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. Real exam evidence (explicitly tagged by source year, 2013-2025) shows two distinct shapes: opposite-face deduction from multiple cube views, and dice-throw probability.

Q: Foundational rule: On a standard die, what do opposite faces always sum to, and why does this matter for solving these puzzles?

A: Opposite faces always sum to 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4) on a STANDARD die — but TNPSC dice puzzles often use lettered or non-standard-numbered faces specifically to stop you from relying on this shortcut, forcing you to actually deduce relationships from the given views instead.

Q: Method — deducing an opposite face from adjacency information: If face 2 is adjacent to faces 3, 5, and 6, what must be true about face 1's relationship to face 4?

A: Since 2 is adjacent to 3, 5, and 6, those three faces can't be opposite 2 — leaving only 1 or 4 as 2's possible opposite. With four faces (3,5,6, and whichever of 1/4 is also adjacent) surrounding face 2, the remaining face must be its opposite, and separately, on a standard 6-face die, this kind of constraint typically forces 1 and 4 to be adjacent to each other (since they're not the 2-pair) — real exam answer: '1 is necessarily adjacent to 4.'

Q: Method — three views of a cube → find the opposite face: Three pictures of the same cube show different combinations of visible letters/numbers. How do you find what's opposite a given face?

A: A face that appears on multiple different views, each time paired with DIFFERENT other visible faces, helps you eliminate possibilities — any face that has been seen adjacent to your target face (in ANY view) cannot be its opposite. Whatever face is never seen adjacent to it across all views is the opposite face.

Q: Method — probability of a sum from two dice: What is the probability of getting a prime-number sum when throwing two dice?

A: Possible sums range 2-12 (36 total equally likely outcomes from 6×6). Prime sums possible: 2,3,5,7,11. Count outcomes for each: sum=2(1 way),3(2),5(4),7(6),11(2) = 15 outcomes. Probability = $15/36$.

Q: Method — basic single-die probability: What is the probability of throwing a number greater than 4 on a single die?

A: Numbers greater than 4 on a standard die: 5 and 6 — that's 2 out of 6 outcomes. Probability = $2/6 = 1/3$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. On a standard die, the numbers on opposite faces always sum to:

- A. 6
- B. 7 ✓**
- C. 8
- D. 9

Explanation: 7 (1-6, 2-5, 3-4). [easy, authored]

2. What is the probability of getting a sum of 7 when two dice are thrown?

- A. $1/12$
- B. $1/9$
- C. $1/6$ ✓**
- D. $1/4$

Explanation: 6 ways to make 7 out of 36 total outcomes: $6/36=1/6$. [medium, authored]

3. What is the probability of throwing an odd number on a single die?

- A. $1/6$
- B. $1/3$
- C. $1/2$ ✓**
- D. $2/3$

Explanation: Odd numbers (1,3,5) = 3 of 6 outcomes = $1/2$. [easy, authored]

4. If face 1 is adjacent to faces 2, 3, 4, and 5 on a die, which face must be opposite face 1?

- A. 2
- B. 3
- C. 4

D. 6 ✓

Explanation: Since 2,3,4,5 are all adjacent to 1, the only remaining face (6) must be opposite it. [medium, authored]

5. What is the probability of getting a sum greater than 10 when two dice are thrown?

A. $1/36$

B. $1/12$ ✓

C. $1/9$

D. $1/6$

Explanation: Sums >10 means 11 (2 ways) or 12 (1 way) = 3 outcomes out of 36 = $1/12$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Grammar: Degrees of Comparison (Positive, Comparative, Superlative)

READING MATERIAL

Tests identifying and correctly forming the 3 degrees (positive/comparative/superlative), including irregular forms and 2 traps: 'one of the greatest' converting to 'than many other' (not 'than any other'), and Latin-derived comparatives (inferior, superior, junior, senior) that use 'to' instead of 'than'.

Q: What are the 3 structures used to express the Positive Degree?

A: 'As...as' (e.g., 'Very few people in this town are as generous as Mr. Mohan'), 'So...as', and 'No other...as...as'.

Q: Real exam: transform 'Wordsworth is one of the greatest English poets' into the comparative degree.

A: Wordsworth is greater than many other English poets. (NOT 'than any other' — 'one of the greatest' implies SEVERAL poets share that top tier, so the comparative must say 'many other', not imply Wordsworth is uniquely superior to every other poet.)

Q: Real exam: which is the correct superlative form among these: 'He is the more fastest runner', 'This is the best cake I have ever tasted', 'That movie was the less interesting of all', 'She is the more talented musician in the band'?

A: 'This is the best cake I have ever tasted' — the others double-mark the superlative ('more fastest') or wrongly use comparative forms ('less', 'more talented') where a true superlative is needed.

Q: Real exam: what degree is the word 'inferior'?

A: Comparative — 'inferior' (like superior, junior, senior — all Latin-derived) is inherently comparative even without the word 'than', and pairs with 'TO' instead of 'than' (e.g., 'inferior to', 'junior to', NOT 'inferior than'/'junior than').

Q: Real exam: "The Amazon is ____ river in the world."

A: The longest (superlative — 'in the world' signals comparison among ALL rivers, requiring the superlative, not comparative 'longer').

Q: Fill in the blank: "He is ____ than his brother."

A: Better (comparative of 'good'; 'best' is the superlative and doesn't fit with 'than').

Q: What is the superlative form of 'happy', and the comparative form of 'bad'?

A: Happiest (superlative of happy); Worse (comparative of bad — irregular, not 'badder').

Q: Identify the degree: "She is tall."

A: Positive degree (no comparison being made, just a plain quality statement).

Q: Real exam: which sentence correctly uses the comparative degree: 'He is smarter than any one in the class', 'This sum is less complicated than the previous one', 'This bus is less crowded than that crowded one', 'The game is more eager than expected'?

A: 'This sum is less complicated than the previous one' — the others have logical/grammatical errors: 'than any one in the class' is illogical since he IS one in the class (needs 'anyone else'); 'that crowded one' is redundant with 'less crowded'; 'more eager' is the wrong adjective pairing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "He is ____ than his brother."

- A. good
- B. best
- C. better ✓**
- D. more good

Explanation: better. [easy, web-research]

2. Which is the superlative form of 'happy'?

- A. Happier
- B. Most happy
- C. Happiest ✓**
- D. More happy

Explanation: Happiest. [easy, web-research]

3. Identify the positive degree:

- A. She is taller

B. She is tall ✓

C. She is the tallest

D. She is more tall

Explanation: She is tall. [easy, web-research]

4. Choose the comparative degree of 'bad'.

A. Worse ✓

B. Badder

C. Baddest

D. More bad

Explanation: Worse. [medium, web-research]

5. Transform into comparative degree: "Wordsworth is one of the greatest English poets."

A. Wordsworth is greater than many other English poets. ✓

B. Very few English poets are as great as Wordsworth.

C. No other English poet is as great as Wordsworth.

D. Wordsworth is greater than any other English poet.

Explanation: Wordsworth is greater than many other English poets. [hard, question-bank-2017]

6. "The Amazon is ____ river in the world."

A. the most longest

B. the longer

C. the longest ✓

D. longest

Explanation: the longest. [medium, question-bank-2025]

7. Identify the sentence with the correct superlative form.

A. He is the more fastest runner in the team.

B. This is the best cake I have ever tasted. ✓

C. That movie was the less interesting of all.

D. She is the more talented musician in the band.

Explanation: This is the best cake I have ever tasted. [medium, question-bank-2025]

8. What is the degree of the word 'inferior'?

A. Positive

B. Superlative

C. Comparative ✓

D. All the above

Explanation: Comparative. [hard, question-bank-2025]

9. Choose the sentence with the correct use of the comparative degree:

A. He is smarter than any one in the class.

B. This bus is less crowded than that crowded one.

C. This sum is less complicated than the previous one. ✓

D. The game is more eager than expected.

Explanation: This sum is less complicated than the previous one. [hard, question-bank-2025]

10. Which sentence correctly uses 'junior'/'inferior'-type comparatives?

A. He is junior than me.

B. He is junior to me. ✓

C. He is more junior than me.

D. He is the most junior than me.

Explanation: He is junior to me — Latin-derived comparatives (junior, senior, inferior, superior) pair with 'to', not 'than'. [medium, question-bank-2025]